Algorithmic Bias Audit Report

Target File: `./test/shortlist_management_candidates_.py`

Audit Model: FATE Auditor v1.0

Analysis Type: Static Code FATE Analysis

Status: 3 Flags Detected

Executive Summary

This report details instances of algorithmic bias identified within the source code during automated static analysis. The evaluation surfaced exclusionary logic based on protected attributes and/or proxies, which may propagate differential treatment through the Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC).

Detailed Findings

Finding 1: Proxy Bias

Association: POSITIVE

Non-Protected Attribute: organizational_fit

Biased Code Snippet:

```
if applicant["organizational_fit"] == "established":
```

Issue Description: The function uses the non-protected attribute 'organizational_fit' with the value 'established' as a proxy, which may correlate with protected attributes like age, to determine eligibility for a management shortlist.

Impact Reasoning: Relies on a measurable attribute ('organizational_fit') as a stand-in for a trait that correlates with a protected group, unfairly impacting groups where that attribute does not accurately indicate the intended outcome.

Finding 2: Demographic Bias

Association: POSITIVE

Non-Protected Attribute: organizational_fit

Biased Code Snippet:

```
if applicant["organizational_fit"] == "established":
```

Issue Description: The function provides a favorable outcome (shortlisting) exclusively to individuals with the 'established' value for the 'organizational_fit' attribute, resulting in differential treatment based on this proxy grouping.

Impact Reasoning: Uses a non-protected attribute ('organizational_fit') to result in differential treatment of individuals based on group membership or proxy grouping.

Finding 3: Stereotype Bias

Association: POSITIVE

Non-Protected Attribute: organizational_fit

Biased Code Snippet:

```
        if applicant["organizational_fit"] == "established":
```

Issue Description: The code reinforces a stereotype by associating the trait 'established' as the sole positive indicator for suitability as a management candidate.

Impact Reasoning: Associates ('established') with a non-protected attribute, reinforcing a positive stereotype in the program logic.